

Syllabus

Fall Semester 2025

Course Title	Korean History		Course Code		Credit		2	Classroom	Hyungsul 204
			Type	Lecture	Hours	2			
Teacher	Name	Class no.	Office	Office hours	Contact		E-mail		
	YOON, Sungoh		Hyungsul 104	By appointment			sungoh.yoon@ksa.hs.kr		

1. Course Description

Incorporating feature films, documentaries, novels, and original sources in translation, this introductory course provides an overview of Korean culture and history with an emphasis on the major changes and continuities in Korea in the modern period (1876 to the present). We will explore particular themes relevant to understanding Korea such as Confucianism, modernization, colonialism, nationalism, industrialization, democratization, gender relations, US-Korea relations, and popular culture in contemporary Korea.

2. Core Target Competencies

Subject Core Competencies						

Course Goals

- Understanding of Korean culture and history, leading to critical reflection on contemporary issues surrounding the peninsula.
- Ability to read and interpret texts as historical sources for the past and the present, i.e. understand the difference between primary and secondary sources.
- Ability to write using texts to make persuasive arguments, written clearly and concisely.

3. Textbooks and References

A. Textbook: *A Korean History for International Readers: What Do Koreans Talk About Their Own History and Culture?* by The Association of Korean History Teachers

B. References

- Ramon Pacheco Pardo, *Shrimp to Whale: South Korea from the Forgotten War to K-Pop*
- Michael E. Robinson, *Korea's Twentieth Century Odyssey: A Short History*

4. Class Method

- A. Lectures
 - B. Reading Materials and Films
 - C. Discussions and Presentations
- ※

5. Evaluation

A. Evaluation Criteria

In-class activity (Presentation and Discussion)	Final project (Optional)	In-class Writing Exercises (2 times)	Final exam	Attendance and Attitude	Sum
40	Extra Credit	40	10	10	100

B. Evaluation Method

GRADING

The grading for this course is designed to evaluate student mastery of the course goals, focusing on Korean culture and history that would be relevant to understanding contemporary Korea. The assignments require students to read and interpret texts as historical sources for the past and present, differentiating between primary and secondary sources. Assignments also require students to write intensively, focusing on constructing effective arguments using texts as evidence. Upon completion of the course, students will be able to communicate verbally and in writing a basic understanding of Korean culture and history.

6. Criteria for Awarding Credits

- ☞ Pass: In the case of receiving a **score of 80 or more** out of 100 according to the criteria of the evaluation method.
- ☞ **Students with excellent academic achievement are recommended for the Academic Excellence Award and the Principal’s Award, and are recorded according to core competencies in the Subject Details. However, students with poor academic attitude or poor attendance are excluded.**

WRITTEN ASSIGNMENTS ASSESSMENT GRID

	A: Great	B: Good	C: Okay	D: Poor	F: Fail
Structure & Organization Clear introduction, thesis, argument & conclusion					
Argument & Content Thesis supported by evidence; convincing arguments made with credible evidence and refutation of counterarguments					
Language Use of clear sentences, good wording, strong voice					
Mechanics Spelling, grammar, citation					

Course Policy

- **Plagiarism:** All written work should be composed in the student's own words and the ideas of others should be properly cited. It is the responsibility of all students to know and adhere to KSA's policy on plagiarism. If you have any questions concerning this policy or about documentation of sources in work you produce in this course, feel free to ask me.
- **Assignments:** All reading and written assignments are required and should be done before class. Late assignments will be deducted a full letter grade for each late day (i.e. A to a B, B to a C...).
- **Attendance:** Regular class attendance is mandatory. More than 3 absences can result in a failing grade for the course.
- **Gadgets:** All communication devices must be turned off for the duration of the class, and laptops may be used only to take notes.
- **Final note:** **This syllabus may be modified throughout the semester, and it is the responsibility of each student to keep up to date of any and all announcements made in class.**

7. Weekly Plans

Week (period)	Topic and Contents	(Notes)
Week 1 02/20~02/24	Introduction Class Overview	
Core Competencies	◆	
Week 2 02/27~03/03	The Beginning of the Korean History	
Core Competencies	◆	

Week 3 03/06~03/10	The Beginning of the Three Kingdoms Period	
Core Competencies	♦	
Week 4 03/13~03/17	Unified Shilla and Balhae in the South and North	
Core Competencies	♦	
Week 5 03/20~03/24	Rise of a United Power Named Goryeo	
Core Competencies	♦	
Week 6 03/27~03/31	A New Historical Perspective Formed Through Struggles Against Foreign Powers	
Core Competencies	♦	
Week 7 00/00~00/00	Rise of a New Dynasty, Joseon: The Beginning of New Traditions	
Core Competencies	♦	
Week 8 00/00~00/00	Chuseok Holidays	
Week 9 00/00~00/00	Midterm Exams	
Core Competencies	♦	
Week 10 00/00~00/00	The Spread of Confucian Culture	
Core Competencies	♦	
Week 11 00/00~00/00	Various Attempts for Changes	

Core Competencies	◆	
Week 12 00/00~00/00	Joseon at a Turning Point	
Core Competencies	◆	
Week 13 00/00~00/00	An Unfulfilled Dream of Constructing a People's Nation; Subsequent Colonization and Oppression by the Japanese	
Core Competencies	◆	
Week 14 00/00~00/00	Koreans' Preparation for Liberation	
Core Competencies	◆	
Week 15 00/00~00/00	The Establishment of a Democratic Republic and the Country's Division	
Core Competencies	◆	
Week 16 00/00~00/00	◆ Changing Korean Peninsula, Dynamic Korea	
Core Competencies		
Week 17 00/00~00/00	Final Exams	

※ The above plans may change according to the academic schedule.

[Reference] Syllabus Competence Reference

1. Analytical and Creative Thinking	2. Complex Communication	3. Leadership and Teamwork	4. Digital/ Quantitative Literacy	5. Global Perspective	6. Adaptability/ Progression/ Spirit of Adventure	7. Integrity and Ethical Decision Making	8 Habits/ Mindset
Ability to identify, manage and deal with complex problems	Ability to understand and express themselves in two or more languages	Ability to be the first to come up with and present new ideas	Ability to understand, use and apply digital technology	Ability to develop an open mind about the traditions or values of others	Ability to develop flexibility, agility and adaptability	Ability to sustain an empathetic and understanding perspective	Sincerity
Ability to see through prejudice and identify reliable information and uncertain information	Ability to communicate clearly with diverse audiences or readers	Ability to influence people to follow themselves, rather than lead them through directives, orders, or authority	Ability to create digital contents and media	Ability to understand the history, politics, religion, and culture of another region	Ability to challenge unfamiliar situations	Ability to cultivate sincerity, honesty, fairness, and respect creativity	Creativity
Ability to find quality information in the flood of information	Ability to listen attentively	Ability to build trust, resolve conflicts, and support others	Ability to utilize multimedia resources to effectively communicate one's ideas in a variety of formats	Ability to use one or more of the international languages used worldwide	Ability to explore and experiment	Ability to display moral courage in the face of injustice	A love of learning and curiosity
Ability to articulate meaningful questions	Ability to speak effectively and coherently	Ability to facilitate group discussions or discussions, build consensus, and negotiate outcomes	Ability to master and use higher mathematics	Ability to use technology to connect people and things around the world	Ability to word effectively in situations of ambiguous or changing priorities	Ability to act responsibly for the benefit and happiness of the greater community	Resilience/elasticity
Ability to analyze and create ideas or knowledge	Ability to write concisely and clearly, considering the diversity of readers	Ability to teach, guide, and counsel Ability to seek help from others	Ability to understand traditional or recently emerging fields such as mathematics, science, technology, environmental science, robotics, geometry, cellular automata, nanotechnology, and biotechnology	Social and intellectual skills to effectively navigate information across multiple cultures	Ability to see failure as a lesson and to accept that innovation is made up of frequent failures and small successes	Ability to have an intrinsic understanding of ethical issues or dilemmas about new media or new technologies	Perseverance/patience
Ability to devise and test	Ability to explain	Ability to collaborate on		Ability to use 21 st century core	Ability to develop a sense of	Ability to make rational and	Self-efficacy

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solutions to problems by trial and error	information and persuasively engage others in an engaging way	tasks, manage groups, and delegate responsibilities		competencies such as communication skills, collaboration skills, critical thinking skills, creativity to properly understand and deal with global issues	independence to seek new roles, ideas, or strategies	ethical decisions on complex issues	
Ability to think of different ways to cope		Ability to listen and practice goals		Ability to learn from and collaborate with people from different cultures, religions and lifestyle through mutual respect and open dialogue	Ability to develop the knowledge and competencies necessary to start a business and run a business		Stress management skills
Ability to develop knowledge and perspectives that are not limited to one field but span multiple fields		Ability to share credit for success		Ability to generate diverse ideas and exploit social and cultural differences to get things done			Time management skills
Ability to make sustained inferences							
Ability to put things together or adapt them to new uses and situations							
Ability to solve new problems that cannot be solved through established rules							
Ability to use knowledge or creativity to solve complex real-world problems							

1. Complex Problem-Solving Skills	Ability to solve new and unclear problems that may arise in complex real-world situations
2. Critical Thinking Skills	Ability to compare and analyze the strengths and weaknesses of various solutions or approaches to a given problem using logic and reasoning
3. Creativity	Ability to come up with novel ideas when given a certain topic or situation or to suggest a creative method in the process of solving a problem
4. Human Resource Management Skills	Ability to select the most suitable person for a specific task and manage them to achieve maximum work performance through motivation, and systematic efficient management
5. Ability to Collaborate	Ability to adjust one's own behavior in response to the behavior of others
6. Emotional Ability	Ability to perceive other people's reactions and understand why they react the way they do
7. Judgement and Decision-making Skills	Ability to make the most rational judgement and decision by analyzing the costs and benefits of a specific situation or problem
8. Orientated Towards Service	Ability to actively seek ways to help others
9. Negotiation Skills	Ability to bring together parties who differ in ideas or interests and try to reduce those differences
10. Cognitive Flexibility	Ability to apply different kinds of rules or principles to rearrange and reorganize things in different ways